Once you have a certificate, you need to configure Kestrel to use it to serve HTTPS traffic. In chapter 27 you saw how to set the port your application listens on with the `ASPNETCORE_URLS` environment variable or via the command line, and you saw that you could provide an HTTPS URL. As you didn't provide any certificate configuration, Kestrel used the development certificate by default. In production you need to tell Kestrel which certificate to use.

You can configure the certificates Kestrel uses in multiple ways. For a start, you can load the certificate from multiple locations: from a .pfx file, from .pem/.crt and .key files, or from the OS certificate store. You can also use different certificates for different ports, use a different configuration for each URL endpoint you expose, or configure Server Name Indication (SNI). For full details, see the "Replace the default certificate from configuration" section of Microsoft's "Configure endpoints for the ASP.NET Core Kestrel web server" documentation: http://mng.bz/wvv2.

The following listing shows one possible way to set a custom HTTPS certificate for your production app by configuring the default certificate Kestrel uses for HTTPS connections. You can add the `"Kestrel:Certificates:Default"` section to your appsettings.json file (or use any other configuration source, as described in chapter 10) to define the .pfx file of the certificate to use. You must also provide the password for accessing the certificate.

Listing 28.1 Configuring the default HTTPS certificate for Kestrel using a .pfx file

```
{
  "Kestrel": {                          ❶
    "Certificates": {                   ❶
      "Default": {                      ❶
        "Path": "localhost.pfx",        ❷
```